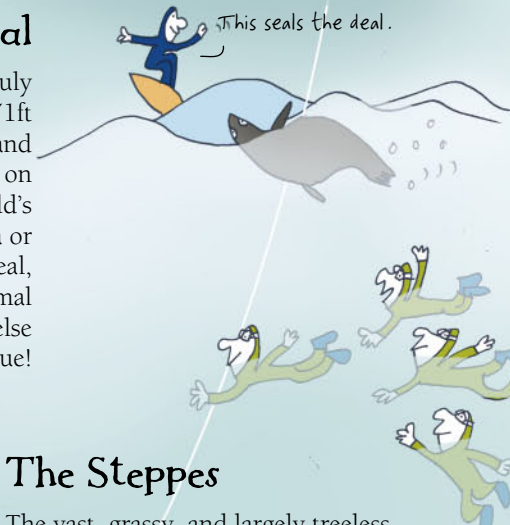


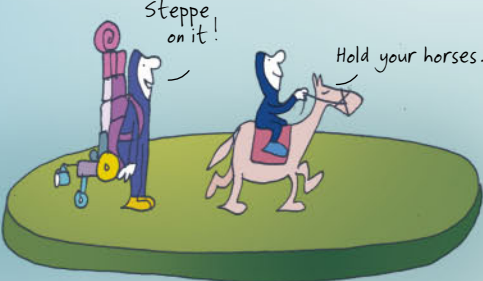
Lake Baikal

Siberia's Lake Baikal is truly record-breaking: with a depth of 5,371ft (1,637m) it is the world's deepest lake and holds the largest body of freshwater on Earth—more than one-fifth of the world's total supply. Being home to the nerpa or Baikal seal, the world's only freshwater seal, as well as 1,700 other plant and animal species that can't be found anywhere else on Earth, Lake Baikal is positively unique!



The Steppes

The vast, grassy, and largely treeless plains known as the steppes stretch from the Black Sea in the west through Ukraine, southern Russia, and Kazakhstan to Mongolia in the east. The fertile black soil is good for growing wheat and other crops, and for rearing sheep, goats, and horses.



Gobi Desert

The Gobi Desert of northern China and southern Mongolia is Asia's largest desert. Most of it is bare rock rather than sand and suffers from frequent dust storms. The Gobi is punctuated by extreme weather conditions, with long harsh winters and scorching summers.



Himalayas

The world's highest mountain chain, the Himalayas formed when the Indo-Australian plate collided with the Eurasian plate. There are 14 mountains in the world that exceed a height of 26,247ft (8,000m), all of which are located in this vast mountain range, including the mighty Everest—the world's highest mountain at 29,035ft (8,850m).

